

Paradiem 

The Morning Brief

AUGUST 29, 2026

Hawkish Warsh

Chair Warsh's first Jackson Hole keynote repriced September rate-decision odds toward a hike, precious metals sold off materially, and the FCI semiconductor sleeve gave back a portion of the week's Nvidia-driven bid.

S&P 500 (SPY, FRI CLOSE)	NASDAQ (QQQ, FRI CLOSE)	NVDA (FRI CLOSE)	SEPT HIKE ODDS (CME)	FEAR & GREED
\$769.35 · ↑~0.5% on the week	\$716.43 · ↑~0.9% on the week	\$217.55 · ↓4.58% Fri (↑~1% wk)	~60% · up from ~35% Thu	~58 · Greed (CNN; drop crypto fallback)

SECTION 01

Markets — Week in Review: Chair Warsh's Hawkish Jackson Hole Keynote Repriced the September Rate-Decision Distribution Toward a Hike, the FCI Semiconductor Sleeve Gave Back a Portion of the Nvidia-Driven Bid on Friday, and the Precious-Metals Complex Declined Sharply on the Dollar-and-Real-Yield Read

THE WEEK'S DOMINANT THEME: WARSH'S COMMUNICATION TURN OVERRODE THE NVIDIA BEAT-AND-RAISE PRINT

Per BEA and BLS releases carried through the week, July core PCE held at ↑3.3% year-over-year with no fresh progress toward the 2% target and the Q2 GDP 2nd estimate held at ↑1.5% annualized with the consumer revised up to ↑3.4%; per Federal Reserve release of Chair Warsh's Friday Jackson Hole keynote, the Chair characterized this summer's inflation readings as better than expected but suggested underlying trends have not meaningfully improved and indicated the Fed retains additional work on the inflation mandate. Per CNBC and Benzinga coverage of the CME FedWatch response, September-meeting probabilities for a quarter-point rate increase moved to approximately 60% Friday from roughly 35% Thursday, a repricing that overrode the Nvidia beat-and-raise Wednesday-through-Thursday reaction and pulled the sleeve breadth back through Friday's close. Per data drop, SPY closed Friday ↓0.23% at \$769.35 with QQQ ↓0.65% at \$716.43 and IWM ↓1.35% at \$295.75, while the sector composition inverted materially against Thursday's tape: XLK ↓1.55% led the fade and XLU ↓1.04% and XLI ↓0.93% joined on the duration-and-rate-sensitive read, while XLC ↑1.42%, XLY ↑1.15%, and XLE ↑0.63% led the offset. Per web-cited weekly summaries, the S&P advanced approximately ↑0.5% on the week and the Nasdaq approximately ↑0.9% even after Friday's fade, with NVDA finishing approximately ↑1% for the five-session sequence despite the Friday ↓4.58% reversal at \$217.55.

S&P 500 (SPY, FRI CLOSE)	\$769.35 · ↑~0.5% on the week
NASDAQ (QQQ, FRI CLOSE)	\$716.43 · ↑~0.9% on the week
FCI BOTTOM-5 FRIDAY	MRVL ↓10.28% · MARA ↓10.11% · HUT ↓8.85%
PRECIOUS METALS (FRI)	GLD ↓3.24% · SLV ↓4.38% · AEM ↓4.27%
DIGITAL-ASSET ETFS (FRI)	IBIT ↓3.07% · ETHA ↓2.65%
BITCOIN (LIVE)	~\$79,500 · Below \$81K weekly peak

THE PRECIOUS-METALS COMPLEX DECLINED SHARPLY ON THE DOLLAR-AND-REAL-YIELD READ — THE DEBASEMENT-BID EXPRESSION COMPRESSED NOTABLY ACROSS THE PHYSICAL-AND-MINER LEGS AND COMPOUNDED ON THE SEMI-SLEEVE FADE

Per data drop, gold (GLD) closed Friday ↓3.24% at \$408.89 and silver (SLV) ↓4.38% at \$60.02, while the FCI precious-metals miner expression tracked the fade with AEM ↓4.27% at \$206.25; per Benzinga coverage cited in the data drop headlines on Warsh's remarks and mining-stock reaction and on the parallel gold-and-bitcoin sell-off framed against the

September rate-hike-odds jump to approximately 60%, the primary driver was the reset in the September rate-decision distribution alongside a stronger dollar and higher short-end real yields. Per data drop, the FCI semiconductor sleeve read the same signal: MRVL ↓10.28% at \$216.62 on softer fiscal 2028 detail post-print (per Motley Fool and CNBC coverage of the release commentary on the Google custom-chip timing), NVDA ↓4.58% at \$217.55, LRCX ↓5.24% at \$301.90, AMD ↓2.33% at \$465.58, and TSM ↓2.29% at \$417.52, while HOOD ↓5.01% at \$104.26 and SOFI ↓5.84% at \$18.06 gave back a fraction of the week's fintech bid. Per data drop, ServiceNow (NOW, FCI growth sleeve) held the Thursday Anthropic-partnership tailwind with NOW ↑4.54% at \$144.71 and SPGI ↑1.72% at \$442.89, while SYK ↑2.66% at \$330.69 led the dividend sleeve; for FCI positioning, the composition — a broad hawkish repricing that compressed both the debasement hedge and the concentrated semi-and-crypto expressions — sets the sequence into a shortened Labor Day-holiday trading week with the September FOMC meeting sitting seventeen calendar days out.

A single communication signal that repriced both the debasement hedge and the AI-compute leg in the same session tends to leave the sleeve reading the incremental data print rather than the prior release. Think Like an Owner.

Geopolitics — Iran's Navy Asserted Full Operational Control Over the Strait of Hormuz as the US Extended Sanctions to Egyptian Bank Branches at the Six-Month Mark of the Iran War, Ukrainian Drones Continued the Deep-Range Refinery Campaign, Israel Struck a Hamas Operative in the West Bank, and the Trump-Xi Overcapacity Tariff Continues to Advance Toward the September 24 Washington Summit

IRAN'S NAVY ASSERTED FULL OPERATIONAL CONTROL OVER THE STRAIT OF HORMUZ — A FRAMING THAT COMPLICATES THE IRAN-OMAN BILATERAL CORRIDOR DISCUSSION — AND THE US MARKED THE SIX-MONTH WAR MILESTONE BY EXTENDING SANCTIONS TO EGYPTIAN BANK BRANCHES HANDLING IRAN-LINKED PAYMENTS

Per Reuters coverage cited in the data drop headlines on Iran's naval command posture toward the Strait, on the compound of sanctions and war on the Iranian economy, and on the US extending secondary-sanctions enforcement to Egyptian bank branches at the six-month mark of the war, Iran's naval command issued a statement asserting full operational control of the Strait — a communication signal that reads against the bilateral Iran-Oman temporary-corridor framework reported earlier in the week and one that arrived alongside the US extending its secondary-sanctions perimeter to Egyptian bank branches handling Iran-linked payment flows. Per Trading Economics coverage cited in prior briefs, Iran and Oman had outlined a joint proposal to establish a temporary shipping lane and launch a demining effort in the waterway; if taken at face value, the naval-command assertion signals Tehran's posture that any reopening runs through Iranian consent rather than a bilateral Muscat arrangement alone. Per data drop, crude prices held roughly flat on Friday with USO $\downarrow 0.24\%$ at \$129.70 and BNO $\downarrow 0.44\%$ at \$51.48 — a composition consistent with the market pricing in the compound of the Warsh dollar-strength signal against continued physical-supply variability. For FCI positioning, the composition — a hardened Iranian communication posture, a widened US secondary-sanctions perimeter, and a compressed weekly crude tape — keeps the FCI energy sleeve (CVX, CNX, OKE) sitting at the intersection of the physical-friction floor and the near-term diplomatic negotiating window into the September 24 Trump-Xi summit and the November 10 Kuala Lumpur truce expiry captured in prior briefs.

UKRAINIAN DRONES CONTINUED THE DEEP-RANGE RUSSIAN REFINERY CAMPAIGN THROUGH THE LATE-WEEK SEQUENCE — RUSSIAN REFINING CAPACITY APPROACHED ITS LOWEST LEVEL IN MORE THAN TWO DECADES WITH REFINERIES ATTACKED AT LEAST 21 TIMES IN AUGUST

Per Kyiv Independent and Al Jazeera coverage cited earlier in the week (Kuibyshev refinery in Samara Oblast and Afipsky refinery in Krasnodar Krai overnight into Friday), per Bloomberg coverage of the parallel strikes on the Novoshakhtinsky refinery in Rostov region, and per Mezha and Wikipedia coverage of the cumulative campaign, Russian oil refining fell to just over 3.8 million barrels per day in August 2026 — approaching the lowest level in more than two decades — with Russian oil refineries attacked at least 21 times in the month, the highest single-month count recorded in the current campaign. Per data drop, USO closed Friday $\downarrow 0.24\%$ at \$129.70 and BNO $\downarrow 0.44\%$ at \$51.48 — the crude complex held roughly flat as the dollar-strength read from Warsh partially offset the physical-supply signal. For FCI

positioning, the composition — a Ukraine-Russia refinery campaign at the deep-strike range compounding on the still-open Middle East supply variable while a stronger dollar suppresses the near-term crude reflection — keeps the FCI energy sleeve reading through the two-sided physical-friction expression that has sat structurally intact for six months.

ISRAEL EXECUTED A RARE WEST BANK AIR STRIKE AGAINST A HAMAS OPERATIVE, THE TRUMP-XI 7.5% OVERCAPACITY TARIFF CONTINUES TO ADVANCE TOWARD THE SEPTEMBER 24 WASHINGTON SUMMIT, AND THE FED-INDEPENDENCE OVERHANG PERSISTS ALONGSIDE A BESSENT-WARREN EXCHANGE OVER YEN INTERVENTION

Per Reuters coverage cited in the data drop headlines (“Israel kills Hamas operative in rare West Bank air strike, military says”), Israel Defense Forces confirmed an air strike against a Hamas operative in the West Bank — a rare use of air strike in the theater and a composition that extends the incremental Israeli operational tempo alongside the ongoing Gulf-security realignment captured in prior briefs. Per Bloomberg, Semafor,

Fortune, and CSIS coverage carried through the week, the administration continues to prepare an incremental 7.5% overcapacity tariff on Chinese goods to keep the aggregate US-China tariff burden near the approximately 20% level Beijing has signaled as consistent with the current truce, with the announcement engineered around President Xi's September 24 state visit to Washington — the first Chinese state visit in more than a decade; per CSIS coverage, the summit agenda is expected to include AI governance, export controls, Taiwan, and the architecture of the bilateral trade relationship after the November 10 Kuala Lumpur truce expiry. Per CNBC

coverage cited in the data drop headlines ("Bessent attacks Warren over yen intervention query"), Secretary Bessent publicly rebuffed Senator Warren over a question on Japanese yen intervention posture — a communication signal that continues to sit alongside the Warsh-Bessent Treasury-Fed balance-sheet framing debate captured in the Warsh Jackson Hole task-force discussion. For FCI positioning, the composition — Israel operational tempo, US-China tariff advance, and continued Treasury-Fed governance signal — extends the trade-and-geopolitical compound the sleeve has been reading through the third quarter and into the fourth.

SECTION 03

On Our Radar

1. Week Ahead — Labor Day Monday Shortens the Week Ahead of a Loaded Macro Calendar: ISM Manufacturing and JOLTS Tuesday, ADP and the Fed Beige Book Wednesday, ISM Services Thursday, and the August Employment Report Friday. Per NYSE calendar, US equity markets are closed Monday, September 1 for Labor Day, opening the sequence Tuesday; per Schaeffer's Investment Research and FXStreet week-ahead previews, the calendar carries the ISM Manufacturing PMI, July construction spending, and the JOLTS Job Openings & Labor Turnover Survey Tuesday, the ADP National Employment Report and July factory orders and the Fed's Beige Book Wednesday, the July trade balance and ISM Services PMI Thursday, and the August Employment Report (nonfarm payrolls, unemployment rate, average hourly earnings) at 8:30 AM ET Friday. The sequence lands with the September 15–16 FOMC meeting sitting seventeen calendar days out per Federal Reserve calendar, and per CME FedWatch coverage cited earlier in the week, September-meeting hike probabilities repriced to approximately 59% Friday from roughly 35% Thursday on Chair Warsh's Jackson Hole communication turn. For FCI positioning, the composition — a shortened four-session trading week that begins post-holiday with labor-market data cadence culminating in Friday's payrolls print — sets the incremental September rate-decision distribution against a jobs-and-services read that historically tends to move the front-end curve materially in either direction.

2. Marvell Closed Friday ↓10.28% at \$216.62 on Softer Fiscal 2028 Guidance and a Lack of Google Custom-Chip Timing Detail — The FCI Growth-Sleeve Response Function Compressed Materially Against a Nominal Beat-and-Raise on the Quarter. Per Motley Fool, CNBC, and TradingKey coverage of the post-print response, MRVL (FCI growth sleeve) closed the Friday session ↓10.28% at \$216.62 with trading volume near 47.7 million shares (approximately 18% above the three-month average) as the market absorbed the Thursday after-hours release; per the coverage, the company projected fiscal 2028 revenue growth of approximately 50% year-over-year to approximately \$18 billion (above the prior \$16.5 billion forecast) but offered limited incremental detail on the previously announced \$12.2 billion Google custom-chip revenue contribution, a composition that compressed the response function against a beat-and-raise headline. For FCI positioning, the sequence — MRVL ↓10.28% Friday against the NVDA-driven ↑8.74% Thursday response — illustrates the two-sided semi-sleeve read function against high year-to-date positioning; the sleeve response into next week's shortened calendar sits at the intersection of the hawkish Warsh signal and the sequential Google-timing communication track.

3. CrowdStrike Delivered a Beat-and-Raise on Wednesday and Extended the Cybersecurity Read-Through — The FCI FTNT Position Traded ↑9.67% Thursday on the Sleeve Read-Through Before Fading ↓3.92% Friday on the Broad Warsh Reversal. Per CNBC and Benzinga coverage of the CrowdStrike (CRWD, not held by FCI) fiscal Q2 release, the company reported adjusted EPS \$0.31 versus consensus \$0.29 and revenue \$1.47 billion versus consensus \$1.44 billion (approximately ↑26% year-over-year), and per the coverage CEO George Kurtz described the quarter as CrowdStrike's best quarter in company history; per Benzinga coverage of the analyst response, eleven Wall Street firms raised price targets and the shares surged as much as 18% in the Thursday reaction. Per data drop, Fortinet (FTNT, FCI growth sleeve) traded the Thursday cybersecurity sleeve read at ↑9.67% at \$172.78 before fading ↓3.92% at \$166.00 into the Friday close on the Warsh-driven broad tape reversal. For FCI positioning, the composition — a validated cybersecurity beat-and-raise on the AI-security tailwind sitting against a Friday hawkish-repricing broad fade — keeps the AI-and-security enterprise-software thesis compounding into the September-quarter earnings sequence while the Friday reset frames the sleeve-level entry function against the incremental data print.

4. Carson's SPY \$645.80 Support Remains Active — Friday's \$768.31 Intraday Low Left the Level Untouched; No New Levels Set. Per levels.json, Carson's active SPY support at \$645.80 remained untouched through Friday's \$768.31–\$775.30 SPY intraday range per data drop and now sits approximately 16.0% below the current tape at \$769.35. No active resistance levels are on the book following the April 14 breakout of the \$691.90–\$693.20 major zone (both hit that session). With Labor Day Monday closing the exchange, the Tuesday ISM-and-JOLTS open, the Wednesday ADP-and-Beige-Book release, Thursday ISM Services, and Friday's August payrolls print sequencing into the September 15–16 FOMC meeting, the pre-committed FCI deployment discipline (70% of reserves at –25% drawdown, remaining 30% at –40%) continues to frame reactive positioning against any single-session gap through the sequence. Note: the data drop Fear & Greed reading of 68 "Greed" reflects the CNN endpoint falling back to the crypto index; per finhacker.cz historical coverage cited in prior briefs, the CNN stock-market F&G reading sat near 58 "Greed" as of Wednesday's close and is likely to have moderated further on Friday's Warsh reversal — treat as approximate for this brief.